

Dear Zillow Hiring Team,

I am writing to express my interest in the Senior Data Scientist role at Zillow, which was referred to me by Stephanie Almeida. As a homeowner and someone who is interested in real estate as a hobby, Zillow has always appealed to me as a place to work. I enjoy consuming house tour content and house renovation content online while also completing projects around my own house. The Zillow app has many features for searching and looking at available homes which I've had fun using even when I'm not house shopping. In particular, the "Zestimate" feature brings a lot of value by giving the user a quick and accurate estimate for a home's value. As a professional data scientist, getting to delve into housing data to extract insight would be a perfect fit. Because of my interest and my strong background in computer vision, I would be able to offer a valuable perspective on your team.

Over the past eight years at Corning, I have honed my expertise as a data scientist in the computer vision space. I am now eager to apply my experience designing complex, automated systems to the dynamic world of real estate. I bring a proven track record of driving data solutions end-to-end—from initial conception through validation and production deployment. In my current role at Corning I have exemplified this by helping to define new image analysis problems, developing a solution, patenting it, and then delivering the solution to production. The most potent example of this is a patent-pending solution for background correcting some optical aberrations. This background correction technique has enabled the next generation of cover glass for all main brands of smartphone.

Beyond technical execution, I excel at translating complex problems for understanding and communicating practical expectations to stakeholders. In my current role I take complicated technical models and communicate them not only to my senior management but also to our customers. I teach methods with a goal of intuitive understanding and communicate results so they can be interpreted by anyone. Most recently this has been explaining to our customer how we as a metrology team arrive at spec limits for manufacturing.

In my daily work I have learned to optimize my productivity using AI agents and tools. I not only stay up to date, but I actually enjoy learning new and different tools as they are released. My current work setup is Claude Code + VS Code while at home I use Cursor.

Thank you for considering my application and I would welcome the opportunity to learn more about the role.

Sincerely,

Mike Schmidlin